

POKHARA UNIVERSITY
FACULTY OF MANAGEMENT STUDIES

Level: Master	Trimester: Spring	Year : 2026
Programme: MBA/MBA(Finance)/MBA(GB)		Full Marks: 100
Course: Management Information System		Pass Marks: 60
		Time : 3 hrs.

Candidates are required to give their answers in their own words as far as practicable. The figures in the margin indicate full marks.

Section ‘A’
Conceptual Questions

*Attempt **any five** questions from this section* **[5×8=40]**

- 1) Define Management Information System and explain its role in supporting operational, tactical and strategic decision making in modern organizations.
- 2) Differentiate between structured, semi-structured and unstructured decisions. Explain how TPS, MIS, DSS and ESS support these decisions with suitable examples.
- 3) How hardware, software, database, network and cloud services support business information systems?
- 4) Evaluate how an organization can align these strategies to create and sustain a competitive advantage, illustrating your answer with real-world examples.
- 5) Critically evaluate the structural differences between e-business and e-commerce models and analyze how the rise of modern e-commerce platforms has disrupted, transformed, or replaced traditional linear business models.
- 6) Explain the major cybersecurity threats faced by digital business platforms. How can organizations protect privacy, data and customer trust?

Section ‘B’
Analytical Questions

*Attempt **any two** questions from this section* **[2×15=30]**

- 7) Critically evaluate how the convergence of Artificial Intelligence (AI), Cloud Computing, the Internet of Things (IoT), and Blockchain is transforming contemporary business operations. Analyze how these technologies transition organizations from reactive to predictive

operational models, substantiating your response with empirical data and real-world corporate case studies.

- 8) Imagine a large-scale retail company implementing an integrated information system that unifies sales, inventory, suppliers, CRM, and online ordering. Analyze with data and visualizations as how TPS, MIS, DSS, ESS must be structurally designed and interconnected to support daily operations, middle management oversight, and long-term strategic steering for this retailer.
- 9) A university wants to improve its student admission, fee collection, attendance, examination and result management process. Identify the current problems and suggest an improved digital MIS solution with suitable modules, workflow and technologies.

Section ‘C’

Comprehensive Questions

Read the context given below and answer the questions that follow: **[30]**

- 10) Airbnb is one of the leading peer-to-peer accommodation platforms in the world. Unlike traditional hotels, Airbnb does not own most of the rooms, apartments or homes listed on its platform. Instead, it uses a digital marketplace to connect hosts who offer accommodation with guests who need short-term rental services. In this business model, trust is very important because both hosts and guests usually do not know each other personally. Guests worry about the quality, safety, cleanliness and reliability of the accommodation, while hosts worry about guest behavior, property damage and payment risk.

To reduce uncertainty, Airbnb developed different trust-building mechanisms within its information system. One important mechanism is the two-sided review system. Guests can rate hosts, and hosts can also rate guests. This is different from traditional hotel booking websites where usually only customers rate hotels. However, Airbnb faced the problem of very high review scores. Most ratings were above 4.5 out of 5, which made it difficult for guests to distinguish excellent listings from average listings. One possible reason was fear of retaliation. Guests might avoid writing honest negative reviews because hosts could also rate them negatively. To reduce this problem, Airbnb changed its review system so that reviews would be shown only after both sides submitted their feedback. Airbnb also used host profiles and photos to create trust. In the early stage, host photos were shown prominently on the search screen. This helped guests feel that they were dealing with real people. However, the use of photos also created ethical problems because users

might make decisions based on appearance, race, gender, age or other personal characteristics. To reduce discrimination, Airbnb removed host photos from the main search screen and focused more on property details, ratings and objective trust signals.

Another important change was the introduction of the Superhost badge. Superhost certification is given to hosts who meet specific performance standards such as good response rate, high guest satisfaction, low cancellation behavior and hosting experience. This badge works as a quality signal and helps guests identify reliable hosts. The Airbnb study shows that Superhosts can receive a price premium in different cities, which means that trust indicators can create business value. Airbnb's platform collects and processes large amounts of data such as host profiles, guest profiles, booking history, prices, reviews, ratings, location data, payment records and user behavior. This data helps guests make booking decisions, helps hosts manage their reputation and helps Airbnb management improve platform rules, reduce discrimination, promote quality and maintain competitive advantage. However, the same system also creates challenges related to data privacy, platform fairness, cyber security, legal compliance and ethical use of customer information.

Answer the following questions:

- a) Explain how Airbnb uses MIS and digital platform design to build trust between hosts and guests. Relate your answer with the basic concept and significance of MIS.
- b) Identify how TPS, MIS, DSS and ESS can be used in Airbnb's platform for booking, review management, pricing, trust monitoring and strategic decision making.
- c) Analyze how Airbnb uses e-business, e-commerce, data management and Business Intelligence to create competitive advantage in the accommodation market
- d) Discuss the cybersecurity, privacy, ethical and legal issues raised by Airbnb's use of reviews, host photos, customer data and platform certification.
- e) Suggest suitable managerial, technological and policy-based controls that Airbnb should implement to improve trust, fairness, data protection and platform performance

